

JONATHAN NADEAU

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Dear Hiring Manager,

When I started at Escape Communications, a defense and telecom electronics manufacturer in Torrance, its engineers had a question they could not answer: has this component failed before? The answer was buried somewhere in 4,038 hardware failure records going back to 2007, in a system whose administrator had left without documentation. As the sole developer on the project, I made those records searchable in about six weeks. I am applying for an analyst role on your team because that is the work I do best: taking data nobody can use and turning it into answers people trust.

I started with the people, not the code. I interviewed the engineering manager and the lead engineer to turn a vague request into a defined scope, then audited the data before building anything. That audit changed the project. The structured fields were thin, and the real engineering knowledge lived in 13,252 free-text comments. I built a Python pipeline that pulled 2,245 distinct component IDs out of that text, and a Streamlit app that lets engineers search by part, serial number, or component, find similar past failures, and refresh the data with one click. I handed it off with a runbook, user guide, and deployment instructions, so it would not become the next undocumented system.

The part I am proudest of is the judgment behind the accuracy. When I sampled the matches by hand, one component category turned out to be about 85% false positives. I removed it, accepted a small loss in coverage, and documented the tradeoff for users rather than hiding it. In another case I built a feature to remove what looked like duplicate records, then learned from the engineers that the "duplicates" were real, separate failures. I pulled the feature. Both taught me the same lesson: accuracy matters more than impressive-looking numbers, and assumptions need to be checked with the people who know the data.

That tool is one of 12 I have built at Escape. In another, I reverse-engineered six undocumented ISO 9001 quality reports and found four material errors in the audit record, including a figure overstated 3.4x and carried forward for two years. Before Escape I logged 1,500+ hours teaching math, which is where I learned to explain technical findings clearly to people who do not share my background.

I have not yet held a full-time analyst title at a larger organization, and I will not pretend otherwise. What I bring is a mathematics degree from UC Santa Barbara, the Google Data Analytics Certificate, UCLA Extension's Data Science Certificate (finishing this December), and a record of shipping finished, verified work. My portfolio is at nadeaujonny.github.io. I would welcome the chance to talk about how I can help your team.

Sincerely,
Jonathan Nadeau